

Planning Context and Proposed Ohio River South Shore Trail (ORSST) Alignment

The City of Aliquippa's West Aliquippa Neighborhood was once its own municipality until it merged with the Borough of Woodlawn in 1928. Much of what exists today in the West Aliquippa Neighborhood was very carefully planned by the Jones and Laughlin Steel Corp. in the early 1900's. The City of Aliquippa has 1.6 miles of riverfront in Section 200 of the ORSST Study Area.



Jones and Laughlin Steel Company, Aliquippa, Pa —73

The City of Aliquippa has experienced massive job losses and a significant loss of tax base with the closure of the former LTV Jones and Laughlin Aliquippa Steel Works. This closure hit the West Aliquippa portion of the City especially hard. When this facility closed, the City lost nearly 10,000 jobs at the plant alone, and hundreds of other jobs affiliated with the operation, many of which were located in this area. A detailed breakdown of the City of Aliquippa's demographic data is provided in Section 300. Some of the poorest census blocks in all of Beaver County occur in the West Aliquippa portion of the City.

History and Cultural Resources

For a detailed discussion of the history of the City of Aliquippa see Section 300. For the portions of the City of Aliquippa that are located within Section 200 there are no sites listed on the National Register of Historic Places. Most of the ORSST Study Area consists of land formally part of the Jones & Laughlin Steel Mill. One site has been identified by Beaver County as a place of local interest and designated with a marker:

- *The Boyhood Home of Henry Mancini.*

Existing Land Use, Parks and Recreation Resources and River Access

The entire riverfront area within Center and Hopewell Townships consist of cleared industrial lands of the former Jones & Laughlin Steel Mill. Beaver County constructed a new County Prison on a riverfront parcel located within Hopewell Township and there has been some additional light industrial/office development constructed to the east of the prison. The entire riverfront area is bound by the CSX Railroad and PA Route 51.

West Aliquippa is a traditional neighborhood setting consisting of a "gridded" street pattern. Although once a mixed use community with commercial and retail activities, with the demise of the steel mill, the area is almost exclusively residential.

There is one existing park and recreation facility located within or close to the proposed trail route:

- *Paul Corsi Jr. Park*

There is currently no public river access in this area. The riverfront is lined with deep parcels that are targeted for new industrial uses, cutting off the potential for public river access in this area.

Environmental Context and Infrastructure

River's Edge and Habitat: The Ohio River's edge in this area is highly disturbed in many locations as a result of its industrial legacy and some portions have bulkheading. There is an unused barge docking facility located east of Elkhorn Run. The river edge topography in this area consists of a very gradual river "flat" extending inland 30 to 40 feet. Beyond this point the topography rises dramatically up to the elevation of the CSX Railroad.

Based on field observations, there are areas of erosion disturbance along the river's edge as well as significant areas of invasive exotic vegetation with poor soil stabilization characteristics. The highly vegetated area near the outfall of Elkhorn Run is highly disturbed but is still a nice naturalized and tranquil setting along the river.

Streams and Stormwater: Elkhorn Run is a day-lighted stream that runs down a valley located between Monaca Borough and Center Township. The stream passes through a large culvert underneath PA Route 51 and the CSX Railroad right-of-way. The outfall area is heavily eroded and exhibits severe disturbance from major storm events.

There are several stream courses, including Jones Run, running underneath West Aliquippa and its vicinity, all of which discharge directly into the Ohio River. There have been issues over the years associated with the buildup of silt and sediment in these culverts, causing backups and flooding in some areas.

Section 200 – Center Township - Hopewell Township - City of Aliquippa (West Aliquippa Neighborhood)

Community Character and Demographic Overview

Center Township is a primarily suburban township located south of Monaca Borough. The Township has approximately 1.5 miles of Ohio Riverfront located within its limits. The Township's developed area is primarily located on the plateau well above the elevation of the river. Center Township is home to three colleges, along with one of the largest retail centers in the area along PA Route 18/Broadhead Road.

According to 2000 U.S. Census data, Center Township has a population of 11,492 and is 15.4 square miles in area, or 9,846 acres. Historically the Township has seen an average of a 10 percent increase in population from the 1990 population of 10,724 to the 2006 estimated population of 11,765.

The racial makeup of Center Township is 95.4 percent White, 2.9 percent African American, 0.01 percent Native American and 0.4 percent Asian. The per capita income of the township is \$21,143 and 4.6 percent of the population lives below the poverty line, which is much lower than Pennsylvania's rate of 12.1 percent.

Hopewell Township has approximately 1.3 miles of Ohio River frontage in Section 200 of the ORSST Study Area. Hopewell Township wraps around the City of Aliquippa's West Aliquippa neighborhood along the riverfront. A detail description of the community is provided in Section 400.

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Transportation Infrastructure

PA Route 51 is the main east/west roadway that parallels the Ohio River from the City of Pittsburgh through Monaca, across the Monaca Rochester Bridge and to the west. PA Route 51 is designated by PennDOT as the Pennsylvania Bicycle Route A through the entire ORSST Study Area, including through Section 200. PA Route 51 in Section 200 has an average daily traffic volume of approximately 10,000. Currently there is one point of vehicular access connecting PA Route 51 over the CSX Railroad to West Aliquippa and Woodlawn Road, via the 2nd Street Bridge.

Woodlawn Road in Section 200 has been improved or is a very wide concrete roadway in the area of West Aliquippa, from the BET-TECH gate to BCED property located near 7th Street. BCED is proposing to reconstruct Woodlawn Road from 7th Street, east, through BCED's property to the portion of Woodlawn Road that has been improved, near the USG Plant entrance roadway in Section 300.

Economic Development

All three municipalities in Section 200 have extensive brownfields properties targeted for industrial redevelopment within the ORSST study area. All of these properties were part of the former LTV Jones and Laughlin steel mill.

- BET-TECH Property which was originally part of the J&L Steel Mill. This riverfront site consists of a former docking facility and water intake for the mill. Portions of this property have been targeted as possible locations for new industrial development projects being promoted by the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania. Should any project be developed in this area, it will clearly require that Woodlawn Road be fully reconstructed to support the needs of a major new industrial operation. In addition, the CSX Railroad is currently studying various locations for the creation of a new intermodal freight transfer facility and this area is one of the locations under consideration. As Woodlawn Road is reconstructed, either for new industrial uses or the potential CSX intermodal facility or even for smaller reuse plans, the 10' wide sidepath should be included in its design if possible.*

Proposed ORSST Route and Alternatives

There is only one ORSST routing option through Section 200, with one short alternative.

Proposed ORSST Route Description through Section 200

The proposed ORSST trail route through Section 200 would extend from Center Township/Monaca Borough Municipal Line to Section 200/300 break line just east of 7th Street in West Aliquippa. The trail through this section will consist of a continuous 10' wide side path with a 3'-5' wide planted buffer along the railroad side of Woodlawn Road.

Route Characteristic and Issues

Elkhorn Run Area: The ability to create a 10' wide sidepath along a new roadway from Monaca to Aliquippa appears to be feasible but will require more detailed engineering and coordination with BET-TECH as they develop their plans. There is a segment near Elkhorn Run where there is very limited width between the top of slope and the edge of the CSX Railroad right-of-way. This is partly due to the changes that CSX recently made to its track alignment in this area. According to information provided by the engineer from C.J. Betters Enterprises (BET-TECH), the railroad legal right-of-way agreements in this area, which date back to J&L Steel, are very complicated and open to interpretation. More detailed engineering would be required to determine if a two-lane roadway along with a 10' wide sidepath could be created in this area. If it is determined that it is not feasible, Alternative 200A should be studied and if that is not feasible the route may require on-road connection for a very short stretch of this segment.



Upper and Lower Roadways through BET-TECH Property near Elkhorn Run

BCED Future Woodlawn Road: This segment is targeted for a 10' wide gravel side path to be located on the side of the roadway closest to the railroad. BCED is actively pursuing funding to construct a new roadway in this location and if additional engineering and construction funding can be secured, the trail and the roadway could potentially be constructed concurrently.

Proposed Route Lengths

Total Length of Route through Center Township 10' Wide Multi Use Path = 1.5 miles

Total Length of Route through Hopewell Township (Section 200) 10' Wide Multi Use Path = .09 miles

Total Length of Route through the City of Aliquippa (Section 200) 10' Wide Multi Use Path = 1.6 miles

Identified ORSST Routing Alternatives in Section 200

Based on the narrow study corridor in Section 200, there was only one potential and short alternative identified for this section.

Alternative 200A:

Description: This route would connect with the trail located along the top of the river's edge slope in the area of Elkhorn Run. The route would need to extend a distance long enough to allow a moderate trail grade transition between an elevation near the river's mean water elevation and the elevation of the CSX Railroad, an estimated 25' to 30' elevation change.

Issues: This route would serve as an alternative route if the proposed ORSST route is deemed infeasible due to the available width for a new roadway with a sidepath above the culvert over Elkhorn Run. This alternative would locate the trail route at the bottom of the slope, near the edge of the river. The feasibility of this alternative alignment can only be determined once an engineered alignment for a service roadway between the proposed refinery facility and existing dock is determined. A bridge crossing of the day-lighted portion of Elkhorn Run would be required if this route is chosen since a culvert would be suitable in this location due to the nature of the stream outfall width, character and proximity to the Ohio River.



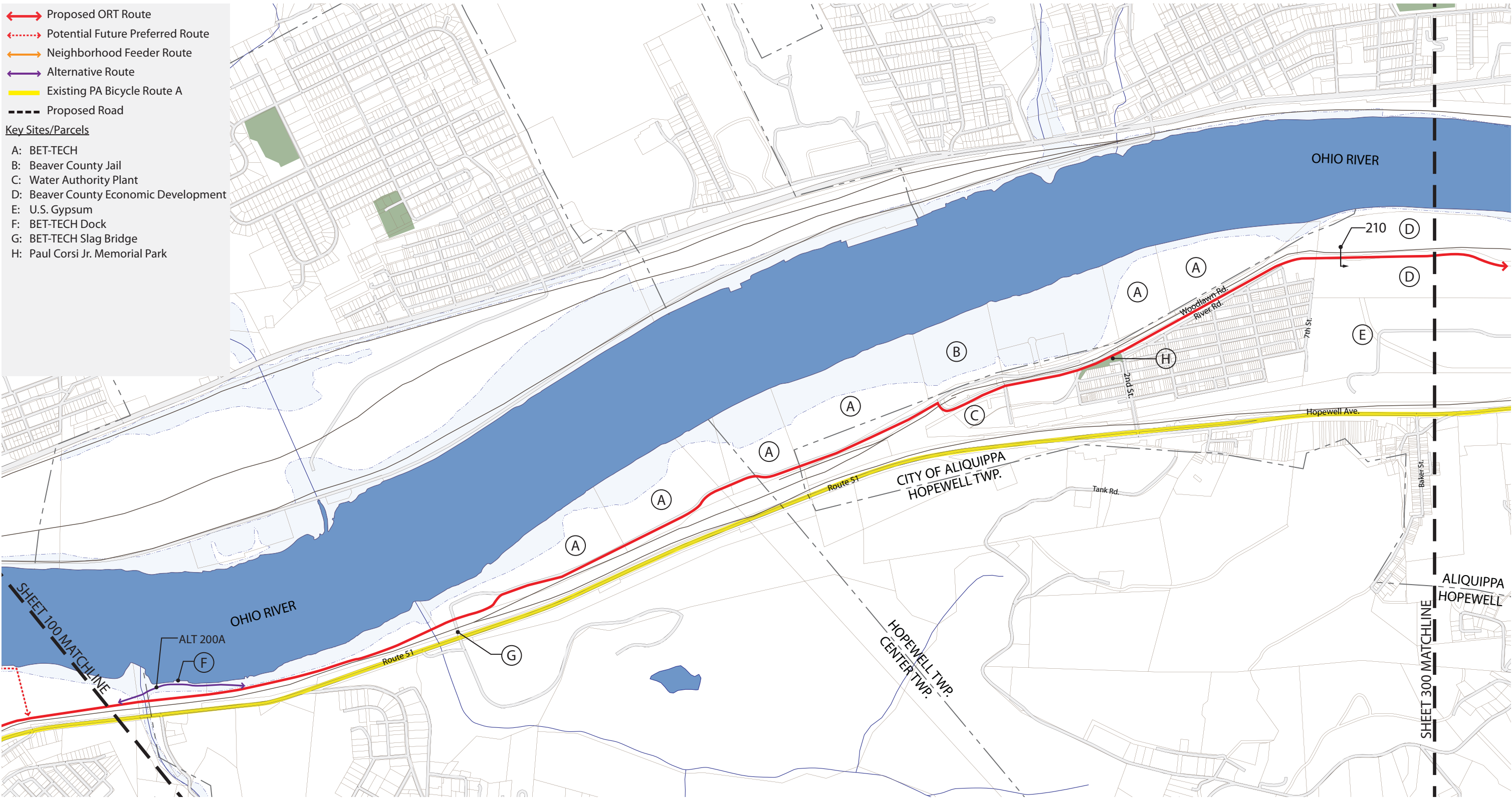
Lower Roadway Area at the Confluence of Elkhorn Run and the Ohio River

LEGEND

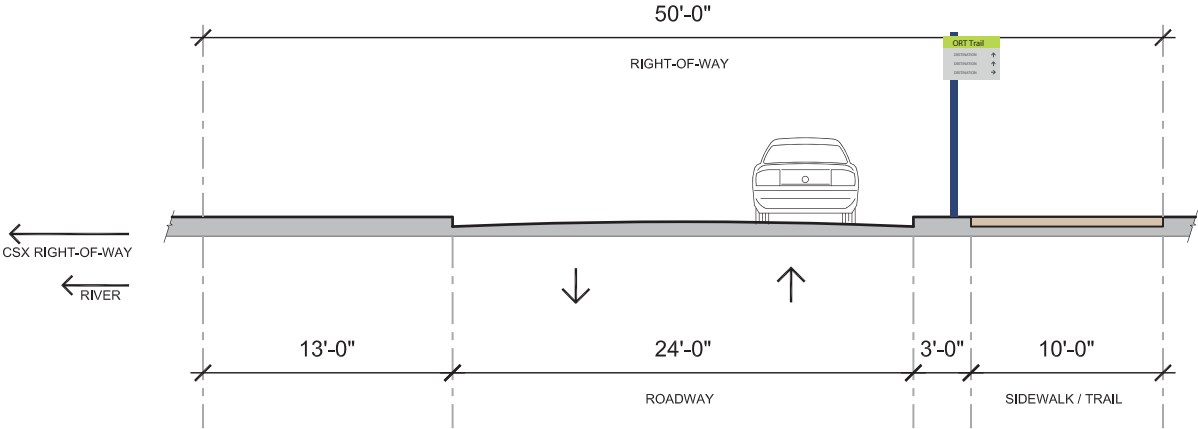
- Proposed ORT Route
- Potential Future Preferred Route
- Neighborhood Feeder Route
- Alternative Route
- Existing PA Bicycle Route A
- Proposed Road

Key Sites/Parcels

- A: BET-TECH
- B: Beaver County Jail
- C: Water Authority Plant
- D: Beaver County Economic Development
- E: U.S. Gypsum
- F: BET-TECH Dock
- G: BET-TECH Slag Bridge
- H: Paul Corsi Jr. Memorial Park



SCALE: Not to Scale NORTH



210 BCED - AND WOODLAWN RD. WITH 50' RIGHT-OF-WAY (PROPOSED)
SCALE: 1"=10'